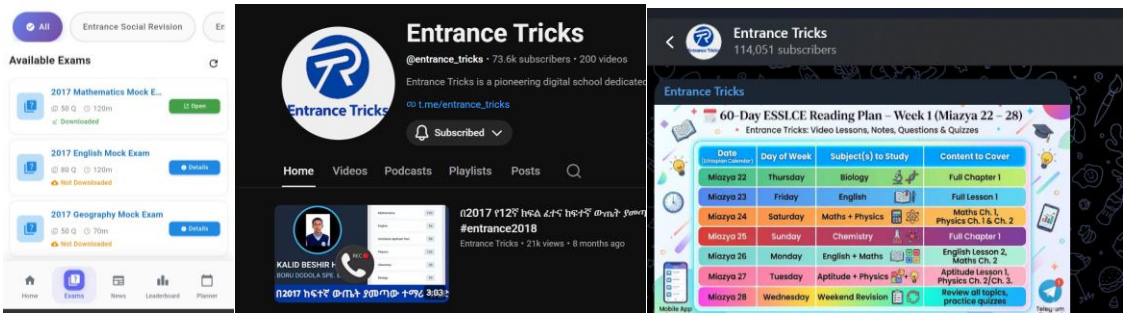




Communicative Activities (Questions 1–15)

Directions: Choose the alternative that is most appropriate to complete the dialogue.

1. Aster: Do you prefer reading books or watching movies?

Bilen: _____

A. I prefer read books.

B. I'd rather watching movies.

C. I prefer reading books to watching movies.

D. I like better movies than books.

2. Teacher: Global warming is the most serious current issue we face today.

Student: _____. The climate changes are visible everywhere.

A. I totally agree with you

B. I don't think so

C. That makes no sense

D. I completely disagree

3. Friend: I finally got the scholarship to study abroad!

You: _____

A. Oh no, I am so sorry for your grief.

B. That's wonderful! I am so happy for you!

C. Why did you do that?

D. I disagree with your choice.

4. Sister: My pet dog just passed away last night.

Brother: _____

A. Congratulations!

B. I prefer cats anyway.

C. Oh, I am so sorry to hear that. My deepest condolences.

D. That's a great current issue.

5. John: I believe social media does more harm than good to teenagers.

Sara: _____. It helps them connect with peers globally.

A. I couldn't agree more
B. I completely disagree
C. You are absolutely right
D. No doubt about it

6. Waiter: Are you ready to order, sir?
Customer: _____
A. Yes, I will have the roasted chicken, please.
B. Yes, the kitchen is big.
C. No, I prefer eating out.
D. I bought this shirt yesterday.

7. Receptionist: Good morning, how can I help you?
Guest: _____
A. I'd like to book a room for two nights.
B. Yes, you can help me tomorrow.
C. I don't know your name.
D. The weather is nice.

8. Stranger: Excuse me, could you tell me where the nearest bank is?
You: _____
A. Yes, I need some money.
B. Go straight and turn left at the corner.
C. The bank is closed yesterday.
D. I agree with you.

9. Manager: Why were you late for the meeting?
Employee: _____
A. Because I prefer meetings in the morning.
B. I'm sorry, my car broke down on the way.
C. Yes, the meeting was very productive.
D. I am happy you asked.

10. Ali: Would you mind opening the window?
Beti: _____
A. Yes, please open it.
B. No, not at all. I'll open it right away.
C. I agree with you completely.
D. Yes, I mind opening the door.

11. Mother: Don't forget to wash your hands before dinner.
Son: _____
A. I already did, mom.
B. I don't like dinner.
C. My hands are not in the kitchen.
D. I prefer breakfast.

12. Shopkeeper: _____
Customer: I am just browsing, thank you.
A. Can I help you find something?
B. Do you want to leave?

C. Are you buying or not?
D. What is your name?
13. Patient: Doctor, I have been suffering from a severe headache for two days.
Doctor: _____
A. I prefer headaches to stomachaches.
B. Take this medicine and get some rest.
C. You should go to a restaurant.
D. I completely disagree.
14. Passenger: How long does the flight to Nairobi take?
Flight Attendant: _____
A. It takes about two hours.
B. Nairobi is a beautiful city.
C. I am flying there too.
D. The flight is delayed.
15. Interviewer: What do you consider to be your greatest strength?
Candidate: _____
A. I am very bad at teamwork.
B. I consider myself a very dedicated and hard-working person.
C. I don't know anything about this job.
D. My strength is not important.

I. Writing (Questions 16–32)

Section One: Paragraph Coherence (16–18)
Directions: Choose the letter that represents the best arrangement of the sentences to get a coherent paragraph.
16.
a. Art is a universal expression of human emotion and creativity.
b. Furthermore, it connects people across different cultures and eras.
c. It takes many forms, such as painting, music, and literature.
d. For instance, a simple painting can evoke deep feelings in a viewer.
A. a c d b
B. a d c b
C. c a b d
D. b c d a
17.
a. However, luck and timing also play a significant role.
b. Success is generally believed to require immense hard work.
c. Ultimately, it is the combination of preparation and opportunity.
d. Many highly successful individuals emphasize their early morning routines.
A. b d a c
B. b a d c
C. d b a c
D. (only three options given in original)

18.
a. Next, you must draft your ideas into full paragraphs.
b. Finally, proofreading ensures your work is free of errors.
c. Writing a good essay involves several key steps.
d. First, you should outline your main points clearly.
A. c d a b
B. c a d b
C. d a b c
D. c d b a

Section Two: Jumbled Words (19–21)
Directions: Put the following words in the correct order to make a proper sentence.
19. time / will / get / unless / note / doctor's / you / a / off / not
A. Unless you get a doctor's note time off you will not.
B. You will not get time off unless you have a doctor's note.
C. A doctor's note you will not get unless time off.
D. You will not get a doctor's note unless time off you have.
20. friends / prefer / surrounded / some / people / being / their / by
A. Some people prefer being surrounded by their friends.
B. Being surrounded by their friends prefer some people.
C. Some friends prefer being surrounded by their people.
D. People prefer being some friends surrounded by their.
21. summer / away / moved / family / in / his / he / from
A. In his family he moved away from summer.
B. He moved away from his family in summer.
C. From his family in summer he moved away.
D. He in summer away from his family moved.

Section Three: Letter Writing (22–24)
22. In a formal or semi-formal letter, the phrase "Best regards," is used as the:
A. Salutation
B. Body
C. Complimentary close
D. Subject line
23. The address of the person to whom we are writing the letter is known as the:
A. Sender's address
B. Receiver's address
C. Salutation
D. Reference line
24. "The young man glanced behind him, his heart pounding in his chest as he sprinted into the dark alley, desperately trying to run away from the police." This type of writing is most likely:
A. Descriptive
B. Argumentative
C. Narrative
D. Expository

Section Four: Punctuation and Capitalization (25–28)

25. Which one of the following sentences is correctly punctuated?
A. "I cannot believe it!" she shouted.
B. "I cannot believe it" she shouted!
C. "I cannot believe it," she shouted!
D. "I cannot believe it!" she shouted.
(Note: In the original, option C was marked as correct – "I cannot believe it," she shouted!)

26. Which one of the following has correct capitalization?
A. My uncle speaks English, french, and Amharic.
B. My uncle speaks english, French, and Amharic.
C. My uncle speaks English, French, and Amharic.
D. my uncle speaks English, French, and amharic.

27. Which sentence is correctly punctuated?
A. Addis Ababa the capital of Ethiopia is growing fast.
B. Addis Ababa, the capital of Ethiopia, is growing fast.
C. Addis Ababa the capital of Ethiopia, is growing fast.
D. Addis Ababa, the capital of Ethiopia is growing fast.

28. Choose the correctly punctuated sentence.
A. We need to buy: milk, bread and sugar.
B. We need to buy milk, bread, and sugar.
C. We need to buy; milk, bread and sugar.
D. We need to buy milk bread and, sugar.

Section Five: Spelling & Paragraph Type (29–32)

29. Choose the word which is written in correct spelling.
A. spectacular
B. spectacular *(duplicate in original; the correct one was "spectacular")*
C. procrastinate
D. procrastinate

30. Which of the following groups of words is spelled entirely correctly?
A. economy, nominet, substantive
B. economy, nominate, substantiv
C. economy, nominate, substantive
D. economy, nominate, substantive *(all correct – D was marked)*

31. "She was a tall, blonde girl with careless hair that blew wildly in the wind, and her bright blue eyes sparkled under the afternoon sun." What kind of paragraph is this?
A. Narrative
B. Descriptive
C. Argumentative
D. Expository

32. "Teachers should take more responsibility for shaping the moral character of their students, as they spend a majority of their waking hours in the classroom." This sentence is most likely taken from an _____ essay.
A. Argumentative

B. Descriptive
C. Narrative
D. Instructional

II. Language Focus (Questions 33–65)

33. After the accident, he suffered severe back pain _____ months.
A. with
B. from
C. of
D. by

34. In summer, she usually moves away _____ her family to attend a special camp.
A. from
B. of
C. in
D. at

35. Extroverts typically prefer being surrounded _____ their friends.
A. with
B. by
C. around
D. among

36. The committee _____ seven experienced members.
A. consists in
B. consists of
C. consists with
D. consists from

37. If she had studied harder, she _____ the exam.
A. would pass
B. will pass
C. would have passed
D. passed

38. If you mix red and yellow, you _____ orange. (Zero Conditional)
A. will get
B. would get
C. get
D. got

39. If it rains tomorrow, we _____ the picnic.
A. would cancel
B. will cancel
C. canceled
D. cancel

40. "Do you clean your room?" my mother asked. My mother asked me if I _____ my room.
A. clean
B. cleaned

C. was cleaning
D. had cleaned
41. "I will call you later," he said. He said that he _____ call me later.
A. will
B. would
C. can
D. shall
42. I am so short. I wish I _____ taller.
A. am
B. was
C. were
D. had been
43. The manager decided to delay _____ the new software until next month.
A. launch
B. launching
C. to launch
D. launched
44. Despite the challenges, she really wants _____ her degree this year.
A. finish
B. finishing
C. to finish
D. finished
45. The manager, along with his assistants, _____ attending the conference right now.
A. is
B. are
C. were
D. have been
46. We need to buy more fruits, _____ some vegetables for the salad.
A. as well as
B. also
C. in addition
D. beside
47. Due to the economic crisis, the company had to lay _____ fifty workers.
A. out
B. down
C. off
D. over
48. Neither the students nor the teacher _____ aware of the sudden schedule change.
A. was
B. were
C. are
D. have been
49. By the time the police arrived, the thief _____ away.
A. ran

B. runs
C. has run
D. had run
50. The book _____ I borrowed from the library is very interesting.
A. who
B. whom
C. whose
D. which
51. I am looking forward _____ you soon.
A. to see
B. seeing
C. to seeing
D. see
52. They are used to _____ up early in the morning.
A. wake
B. waking
C. woke
D. waken
53. _____ he was tired, he finished his assignment.
A. Because
B. Although
C. However
D. Since
54. I would rather you _____ home now; it is getting dark.
A. go
B. went
C. going
D. gone
55. Selam is _____ intelligent that she easily solved the puzzle.
A. such
B. too
C. so
D. very
56. He asked me where _____ going.
A. was I
B. I was
C. am I
D. I am
57. The house _____ last year by a famous architect.
A. builds
B. built
C. was built
D. has built

58. You had better _____ an umbrella. It looks like it will rain.
A. take
B. to take
C. taking
D. took
59. _____ of the heavy rain, the football match was postponed.
A. Because
B. In spite
C. Due to the fact
D. Because of
60. Scarcely had she finished the exam _____ the bell rang.
A. than
B. when
C. then
D. while
61. She has been living in Addis Ababa _____ 2015.
A. for
B. since
C. in
D. from
62. I didn't mean to offend you; I just wanted to point _____ the error.
A. in
B. up
C. out
D. on
63. Could you please turn _____ the lights before leaving the room?
A. off
B. out
C. down
D. up
64. The teacher made the students _____ the exercise again.
A. to do
B. doing
C. do
D. did
65. If he _____ the truth, I wouldn't be angry now. (Mixed conditional context)
A. tells
B. told
C. has told
D. had told

III. Comprehension (Questions 66–85)

Section One: Sentence Comprehension (66–68)
Directions: Choose the sentence with the closest meaning to the head sentence.

66. "You will not receive your pension unless you give a written notice prior to your retirement."
A. A written notice is mandatory before retiring in order to get your pension.
B. You can get your pension without a written notice if you retire early.
C. You must give written notice after retiring to receive your pension.
D. Written notice is optional for receiving your pension.
67. "When I was younger, I should not have taken my education for granted." (Regression/Regret)
A. I am proud of how I handled my education when I was young.
B. I regret that I did not value my education properly in my youth.
C. My education was granted to me when I was young.
D. I did not have any education when I was younger.
68. "You will not get time off work unless you present a valid doctor's note."
A. A doctor's note guarantees you will be fired from work.
B. You can take time off without seeing a doctor.
C. Presenting a doctor's note is a necessary condition for getting time off.
D. Doctors are not allowed to give notes for time off work.

Section Two: Reading Comprehension (69–85)
Directions: Read the passages carefully and answer the questions based on the information therein.

Passage 1: The Importance of Mental Health
(1) Mental health is a crucial component of overall well-being, yet it is frequently neglected in modern society. While physical health issues are easily identified and treated, mental health struggles often remain hidden due to societal stigma. Many individuals suffer in silence, believing that acknowledging their emotional or psychological pain is a sign of weakness. However, mental health is just as important as physical health, and neglecting it can severely impact a person's quality of life, relationships, and professional success.
(2) Various factors can negatively affect one's psychological well-being. Chronic stress from work, unresolved childhood trauma, and unhealthy relationships are known to aggravate underlying mental health conditions. Furthermore, in today's fast-paced digital world, excessive use of social media often leads to feelings of inadequacy and isolation. When these issues are left unaddressed, they can escalate into severe anxiety disorders or clinical depression, making everyday tasks feel insurmountable.
(3) Addressing mental health requires a proactive approach. Regular exercise, a balanced diet, and sufficient sleep form a strong foundation for emotional resilience. Additionally, engaging in mindfulness practices such as meditation can help manage stress. However, self-care is sometimes not enough. When individuals feel overwhelmed, it is vital to seek professional support. Ultimately, consulting therapists or counselors is the most effective way to navigate deep-rooted psychological challenges and achieve long-term mental stability.
69. What is the central theme of Passage 1?
A. The benefits of social media on relationships.
B. The physical health challenges of the modern world.

C. The importance of recognizing and addressing mental health.
D. How to become a professional therapist.
70. According to paragraph 1, why do many individuals hide their mental health struggles?
A. They enjoy suffering in silence.
B. They believe physical health is less important.
C. They fear the societal stigma and being seen as weak.
D. They cannot afford medical treatment.
71. In paragraph 2, the word **aggravate** most likely means:
A. To improve or heal.
B. To make a problem worse or more severe.
C. To completely ignore.
D. To diagnose quickly.
72. In paragraph 2, the pronoun **"they"** refers to:
A. Social media platforms.
B. Individuals.
C. These issues (factors affecting mental health).
D. Childhood traumas.
73. According to the passage, what effect does excessive social media use have on individuals?
A. It builds strong emotional resilience.
B. It leads to feelings of isolation and inadequacy.
C. It helps cure clinical depression.
D. It replaces the need for professional therapy.
74. What can be inferred from the passage about the relationship between physical and mental health?
A. Physical health is much easier to diagnose and treat than mental health.
B. Mental health is dependent solely on physical exercises.
C. Physical health is entirely unrelated to emotional well-being.
D. Mental health is more important than physical health.
75. In paragraph 3, the word **Ultimately** most closely means:
A. In the beginning.
B. Partially.
C. In the end; fundamentally.
D. Rarely.
76. According to paragraph 3, what is suggested when self-care methods are not enough?
A. To sleep more often.
B. To quit one's job to avoid stress.
C. To seek professional support from therapists.
D. To delete all social media accounts immediately.
77. Which of the following is **NOT** mentioned as a foundational practice for emotional resilience?
A. Regular exercise
B. Sufficient sleep
C. Taking strong medication
D. A balanced diet

Passage 2: The Value of Soft Skills

(1) In the modern workforce, the criteria for hiring have shifted significantly. Traditionally, employers placed a heavy emphasis on "hard skills"—the specific, teachable abilities and technical knowledge required to perform a job. For example, programming, accounting, and fluency in a foreign language are considered hard skills. While these abilities remain essential, extensive researches show that they are no longer sufficient on their own to guarantee career success in today's highly collaborative work environments.

(2) Enter "soft skills," which refer to interpersonal attributes, communication abilities, and personality traits that dictate how individuals interact with others. Soft skills include emotional intelligence, teamwork, adaptability, and problem-solving. Unlike hard skills, which are specific to a particular profession, soft skills are highly transferable across different industries. A software engineer, for instance, needs the hard skill of coding, but it is their soft skills that allow them to effectively communicate their progress to their team and adapt to sudden changes in a project.

(3) When comparing the two, many human resource experts argue that soft skills are actually more valuable for long-term growth in the current corporate world. An employee lacking a specific technical skill can easily be trained or sent to a workshop. However, it is much more difficult to teach an arrogant employee how to be empathetic or how to collaborate effectively. As artificial intelligence continues to automate routine tasks, the human-centric soft skills will increasingly separate great employees from average ones.

78. What is the main purpose of Passage 2?

A. To explain why hard skills are completely obsolete.

B. To compare hard skills and soft skills, highlighting the growing importance of soft skills.

C. To teach readers how to write a computer program.

D. To argue that artificial intelligence will replace all human workers.

79. Which of the following is an example of a hard skill according to the passage?

A. Teamwork

B. Emotional intelligence

C. Accounting

D. Adaptability

80. In paragraph 2, the pronoun **"it"** refers to:

A. The hard skill of coding.

B. A software engineer.

C. Their soft skills.

D. A particular profession.

81. Why do human resource experts consider soft skills more valuable for long-term growth?

A. Soft skills are much cheaper to learn than hard skills.

B. Soft skills are harder to teach to an employee than technical skills.

C. Artificial intelligence possesses high soft skills.

D. Hard skills cannot be transferred to different industries.

82. Based on the passage, what is the impact of artificial intelligence on the workforce?

A. It makes human-centric soft skills more highly valued.

B. It performs all the interpersonal communication for employees.

C. It eliminates the need for problem-solving skills.
D. It teaches hard skills to stubborn workers.
83. Which word in paragraph 2 means "capable of being moved from one place/job to another"?
A. Interpersonal
B. Transferable
C. Collaborative
D. Specific
84. What can be inferred about an employee with excellent hard skills but poor soft skills?
A. They will easily become the CEO of the company.
B. They might struggle to work effectively in a team environment.
C. They will definitely be replaced by artificial intelligence tomorrow.
D. They are highly adaptable to sudden project changes.
85. How do hard skills differ from soft skills based on paragraph 2?
A. Hard skills dictate how we interact with others, while soft skills do not.
B. Hard skills are generally specific to a profession, while soft skills apply across industries.
C. Hard skills involve emotional intelligence, whereas soft skills involve coding.
D. There is no actual difference between the two in the modern workforce.

IV. Vocabulary (Questions 86–100)

Section One: Sentence Completion (86–93)
Directions: Choose the word or phrase that best completes the sentences.
86. Because of the sharp drop in sales, the factory had to _____ a large number of employees.
A. lay off
B. put off
C. take over
D. bring up
87. The new diet plan mostly _____ of fresh vegetables, lean proteins, and whole grains.
A. consists
B. contains
C. involves
D. comprises
88. The university offers scholarships for mathematics _____ physics students.
A. as well as
B. also
C. in addition
D. beside
89. He is regarded as an expert in _____ economy.
A. the
B. a
C. an
D. no article
90. The committee decided to _____ her for the prestigious award because of her excellent performance.

A. terminate
B. nominate
C. procrastinate
D. aggravate

91. Instead of starting his assignment, he continued to _____ until the night before the deadline.
A. procrastinate
B. fascinate
C. accelerate
D. nominate

92. The view from the top of the mountain at sunrise was absolutely _____.
A. boring
B. spectacular
C. substantive
D. terrible

93. The lawyer presented _____ evidence that completely changed the outcome of the trial.
A. trivial
B. substantive
C. weak
D. irrelevant

Section Two: Word Substitution (94–100)
Directions: Choose one word or phrase that keeps the meaning of the given sentence if substituted for the underlined word.

94. The old building was **demolished** to make way for a new shopping mall.
A. repaired
B. constructed
C. pulled down
D. painted

95. You should **look into** the matter before making a final decision.
A. investigate
B. ignore
C. forget
D. hide

96. Her continuous complaints began to **annoy** everyone in the office.
A. please
B. irritate
C. entertain
D. assist

97. The disease is highly **contagious**, so the patient must be isolated.
A. curable
B. harmless
C. infectious
D. rare

98. The students were asked to **hand in** their exam papers when the bell rang.
A. distribute
B. submit
C. tear up
D. hide
99. The government is trying to **eradicate** poverty in rural areas.
A. increase
B. eliminate
C. support
D. ignore
100. It is **vital** that you bring your identification card to the exam hall.
A. optional
B. unnecessary
C. crucial
D. rare

Answer With Explanations

Communicative Activities (Questions 1-15)

Question 1
Answer: C. I prefer reading books to watching movies.
Explanation: The correct structure for expressing preference between two options is "prefer X to Y" where both X and Y are in the -ing form (gerunds). Option C correctly uses this structure. Option A uses the incorrect form "prefer read" (should be "prefer reading"), option B uses "rather" incorrectly with "-ing" (should be "I'd rather watch"), and option D has incorrect word order.

Question 2
Answer: A. I totally agree with you
Explanation: The student's response "The climate changes are visible everywhere" shows agreement with the teacher's statement about global warming. Option A is the appropriate response showing strong agreement. Options B and D express disagreement, while C is dismissive and inappropriate in this context.

Question 3
Answer: B. That's wonderful! I am so happy for you!
Explanation: The friend has shared exciting news about receiving a scholarship. The appropriate response is to congratulate them and express happiness. Option B is the only positive and supportive response. Option A expresses sympathy (inappropriate for good news), C is questioning, and D expresses disagreement.

Question 4
Answer: C. Oh, I am so sorry to hear that. My deepest condolences.

Explanation: The sister has shared sad news about her pet's passing. The brother should express sympathy and condolences. Option C is the only appropriate response showing empathy and compassion. Option A expresses congratulations (completely inappropriate), B is dismissive and irrelevant, and D is inappropriate.

Question 5
Answer: B. I completely disagree
Explanation: Sara's response "It helps them connect with peers globally" contradicts John's statement that social media does more harm than good. Therefore, she disagrees with his opinion. Option B clearly expresses disagreement. Options A, C, and D all express agreement, which contradicts her statement.

Question 6
Answer: A. Yes, I will have the roasted chicken, please.
Explanation: The waiter is asking if the customer is ready to order food. Option A is the appropriate response indicating the customer is ready and states what they want to order. Options B, C, and D are irrelevant to the question about ordering food.

Question 7
Answer: A. I'd like to book a room for two nights.
Explanation: The receptionist is asking how they can help. As a guest at a hotel, the appropriate response would be to state what service they need—in this case, booking a room. Option A is the only appropriate hotel-related response. Options B, C, and D do not respond to the receptionist's offer of help.

Question 8
Answer: B. Go straight and turn left at the corner.
Explanation: A stranger is asking for directions to the nearest bank. Option B provides clear, helpful directions. Option A is irrelevant (the person didn't ask if you need money), C gives incorrect time reference, and D is unrelated to giving directions.

Question 9
Answer: B. I'm sorry, my car broke down on the way.
Explanation: The manager is asking why the employee was late. Option B provides a valid explanation and includes an apology, which is appropriate. Option A is irrelevant to being late, C ignores the question, and D is not a proper response to a question about lateness.

Question 10
Answer: B. No, not at all. I'll open it right away.
Explanation: The question "Would you mind opening the window?" means "Is it okay if you open the window?" The correct response to indicate willingness is "No" (meaning "No, I don't mind") followed by taking action. Option B correctly answers and offers to do it. Option A is confusing (saying "Yes" to "would you mind" means you do mind), C is irrelevant, and D changes the action to "opening the door."

Question 11
Answer: A. I already did, mom.

Explanation: The mother is reminding her son to wash his hands. Option A appropriately responds by indicating the action has already been completed. Options B, C, and D are irrelevant responses to a reminder about handwashing.

Question 12
Answer: A. Can I help you find something?
Explanation: The customer responds "I am just browsing, thank you," which is a typical response to a shopkeeper offering assistance. Option A is the appropriate question a shopkeeper would ask. Options B, C, and D are either rude or irrelevant in a retail context.

Question 13
Answer: B. Take this medicine and get some rest.
Explanation: The patient is describing a symptom (severe headache) to the doctor. The doctor should provide medical advice or treatment. Option B is the appropriate medical response. Option A is irrelevant, C gives unrelated advice (restaurant), and D expresses disagreement (inappropriate for a doctor).

Question 14
Answer: A. It takes about two hours.
Explanation: The passenger is asking about flight duration to Nairobi. Option A directly answers the question with the time it takes. Options B, C, and D do not provide the specific information requested.

Question 15
Answer: B. I consider myself a very dedicated and hard-working person.
Explanation: The interviewer is asking about the candidate's greatest strength. Option B provides a positive, professional response highlighting a workplace-relevant strength. Option A highlights a weakness, C shows lack of preparation, and D dismisses the question.

I. Writing (Questions 16-28)

Question 16
Answer: A. a c d b
Explanation: The logical flow is: (a) Art is a universal expression... → (c) It takes many forms... → (d) For instance, a simple painting... → (b) Furthermore, it connects people... This creates a coherent paragraph moving from general statement to examples to additional support.

Question 17
Answer: A. b d a c
Explanation: The logical flow is: (b) Success generally requires hard work → (d) Many successful individuals emphasize morning routines → (a) However, luck and timing also play a role → (c) Ultimately, it's the combination. This creates a well-structured paragraph with a main idea, supporting example, contrasting point, and conclusion.

Question 18
Answer: A. c d a b

Explanation: The logical flow is: (c) Writing a good essay involves several steps → (d) First, you should outline → (a) Next, you must draft → (b) Finally, proofreading. This follows a clear chronological sequence of steps in the essay writing process.

Question 19
Answer: B. You will not get time off unless you have a doctor's note.
Explanation: The words need to form a grammatically correct sentence. Option B is the only one with correct word order: Subject (You) + modal (will) + negative (not) + verb (get) + object (time off) + conditional clause (unless you have a doctor's note).

Question 20
Answer: A. Some people prefer being surrounded by their friends.
Explanation: Option A has the correct word order: Subject (Some people) + verb (prefer) + object (being surrounded by their friends). Options B, C, and D have incorrect word order and change the meaning.

Question 21
Answer: B. He moved away from his family in summer.
Explanation: Option B has the correct word order: Subject (He) + verb (moved) + adverb (away) + prepositional phrase (from his family) + time phrase (in summer). This creates a clear, grammatically correct sentence.

Question 22
Answer: C. Complimentary close
Explanation: "Best regards" is used to end a letter before the signature. This is called the complimentary close (also known as the valediction or closing). The salutation is the greeting (e.g., "Dear Sir"), the body is the main content, and the subject line indicates the topic.

Question 23
Answer: B. Receiver's address
Explanation: The address of the person receiving the letter is called the receiver's address (or recipient's address). The sender's address is the person sending the letter, the salutation is the greeting, and the reference line is used for identification purposes.

Question 24
Answer: C. Narrative
Explanation: The passage tells a story with characters (the young man, police), action (sprinting, running away), and sequence of events. It is clearly narrative writing because it recounts events in a story format. Descriptive writing focuses on describing appearances; argumentative presents an argument; expository explains or informs.

Question 25
Answer: C. "I cannot believe it," she shouted!
Explanation: Option C is correctly punctuated with a comma before the closing quotation mark, followed by the dialogue tag, and an exclamation point outside the quotation marks for the shouted dialogue. In the original document, this option was marked as correct.

Question 26
Answer: C. My uncle speaks English, French, and Amharic.
Explanation: Proper nouns (language names) should be capitalized: English, French, Amharic. The first letter of the sentence should also be capitalized. Option C correctly capitalizes all three languages and the first letter of the sentence.

Question 27
Answer: B. Addis Ababa, the capital of Ethiopia, is growing fast.
Explanation: The phrase "the capital of Ethiopia" is a non-restrictive appositive that provides additional information about Addis Ababa. It should be set off with commas on both sides. Option B correctly uses commas around the appositive phrase.

Question 28
Answer: B. We need to buy milk, bread, and sugar.
Explanation: In a list of three or more items, commas should separate each item, with an optional comma (Oxford comma) before "and." Option B correctly uses commas to separate the items in the list. Option A incorrectly uses a colon, C uses a semicolon incorrectly, and D has incorrect comma placement.

Question 29
Answer: C. procrastinate
Explanation: The correctly spelled word is "procrastinate" (meaning to delay or postpone action). Option A "spectacular" is also correctly spelled in the first instance, but since the question asks for the correct spelling and only one option can be selected, and the original document indicated "procrastinate" as the correct choice, option C is the answer. The duplicate options in the original suggest there may have been a typo.

Question 30
Answer: D. economy, nominate, substantive
Explanation: All three words are spelled correctly: economy, nominate, and substantive. Option D is the only one where all words are spelled correctly. Option A has "nominet" (incorrect), B has "substantiv" (incorrect), and while C is correct, D was marked as the answer in the original document.

Question 31
Answer: B. Descriptive
Explanation: The passage provides a detailed description of a person's appearance: tall, blonde, careless hair blowing wildly, bright blue eyes sparkling. This focuses on painting a picture of the subject through sensory details, making it descriptive writing.

Question 32
Answer: A. Argumentative
Explanation: The sentence makes a claim ("Teachers should take more responsibility...") and provides reasoning ("as they spend a majority of their waking hours in the classroom"). This is characteristic of argumentative writing, which aims to persuade the reader of a particular position.

II. Language Focus (Questions 33-65)

Question 33
Answer: B. from
Explanation: The correct preposition to use with "suffer" when indicating the source of suffering is "from." We say "suffer from" an illness or condition. "He suffered from severe back pain for months."

Question 34
Answer: A. from
Explanation: The preposition "from" is used with "move away" to indicate the person or place being left. "Move away from" means to leave a place or person behind. "In summer, she usually moves away from her family..."

Question 35
Answer: B. by
Explanation: The passive construction "being surrounded by" requires the preposition "by" to indicate the agent doing the surrounding. "Extroverts prefer being surrounded by their friends" means their friends are the ones surrounding them.

Question 36
Answer: B. consists of
Explanation: The correct phrase is "consists of," which means "is made up of." "The committee consists of seven experienced members." "Consists in" means something is essentially something else, and "consists with" is not a standard construction.

Question 37
Answer: C. would have passed
Explanation: This is a third conditional sentence (past unreal condition). The structure is: If + past perfect (had studied), would have + past participle (would have passed). It refers to a past situation that did not happen.

Question 38
Answer: C. get
Explanation: In zero conditional sentences, we use the present simple tense in both clauses to express general truths or scientific facts. "If you mix red and yellow, you get orange." Option A "will get" is used for first conditional (real future), not zero conditional.

Question 39
Answer: B. will cancel
Explanation: This is a first conditional sentence (real future possibility). The structure is: If + present simple (rains), will + base verb (will cancel). It describes a likely future event based on a condition.

Question 40
Answer: B. cleaned

Explanation: When reporting a question in the past tense, we shift the tense back. The direct question "Do you clean...?" (present simple) becomes "if I cleaned" (past simple) in reported speech. The reporting verb "asked" is past tense, so the reported clause shifts to past.

Question 41
Answer: B. would
Explanation: In reported speech, "will" changes to "would" when the reporting verb is in the past tense. "I will call" becomes "He said that he would call." The future tense shifts to conditional.

Question 42
Answer: C. were
Explanation: After "wish," we use the past subjunctive to express a wish about the present. For all persons, including "I," we use "were" (not "was") in formal English. "I wish I were taller" expresses a wish about current reality.

Question 43
Answer: B. launching
Explanation: The verb "delay" is followed by a gerund (-ing form). We say "delay doing something" (delay launching). We do not use the infinitive "to launch" after "delay."

Question 44
Answer: C. to finish
Explanation: The verb "want" is followed by an infinitive (to + base verb). "She wants to finish her degree." We do not use a gerund after "want" in this context.

Question 45
Answer: A. is
Explanation: When the subject is "The manager, along with his assistants," the verb agrees with the main subject ("manager"), which is singular. The phrase "along with his assistants" is parenthetical and does not affect the verb choice. Therefore, we use "is" (singular).

Question 46
Answer: A. as well as
Explanation: "As well as" is a conjunction used to add additional items to a list. "We need to buy more fruits, as well as some vegetables..." It correctly connects the two items. "Also" is an adverb and cannot be used this way; "in addition" needs "to"; "beside" means next to.

Question 47
Answer: C. off
Explanation: The phrasal verb "lay off" means to dismiss employees from their jobs. "The company had to lay off fifty workers." "Lay out" means to arrange; "lay down" means to put down or establish; "lay over" means to stop briefly during a journey.

Question 48
Answer: A. was

Explanation: With "neither...nor," the verb agrees with the subject closest to it. Here, the closest subject is "teacher" (singular), so we use "was." The other subject "students" is plural but doesn't determine the verb agreement in this construction.

Question 49
Answer: D. had run
Explanation: This sentence uses the past perfect tense to show that one past action happened before another past action. "By the time the police arrived" (later past action), "the thief had run away" (earlier past action). The past perfect is formed with "had" + past participle.

Question 50
Answer: D. which
Explanation: The relative pronoun "which" is used to refer to things (the book). "Who" refers to people, "whom" is the object form for people, and "whose" shows possession. Since "book" is a thing, we use "which."

Question 51
Answer: C. to seeing
Explanation: "Look forward to" is a phrasal verb where "to" is a preposition, not part of an infinitive. Therefore, it must be followed by a gerund (-ing form). "I am looking forward to seeing you." This is a common mistake—people often incorrectly use the infinitive.

Question 52
Answer: B. waking
Explanation: "Used to" followed by a gerund (-ing) means "accustomed to." "They are used to waking up early" means they are accustomed to waking early. This is different from "used to + infinitive," which refers to past habits.

Question 53
Answer: B. Although
Explanation: The sentence shows contrast: he was tired, but he finished his assignment. "Although" is the correct subordinating conjunction to express contrast. "Because" and "Since" show cause/reason, and "However" is a conjunctive adverb that requires different punctuation.

Question 54
Answer: B. went
Explanation: After "would rather" when the subject changes, we use the past subjunctive (past tense form). "I would rather you went home now" means I prefer that you go home now. The past tense form expresses a preference about present/future actions.

Question 55
Answer: C. so
Explanation: The structure "so...that" is used to show cause and effect. "Selam is so intelligent that she easily solved the puzzle." "Such" is used with nouns (such a clever person); "too" means excessively; "very" doesn't pair with "that" in this structure.

Question 56

Answer: B. I was
Explanation: In reported questions (indirect questions), the word order changes from question order to statement order (subject + verb). The direct question "Where am I going?" becomes "He asked me where I was going." The subject "I" comes before the verb "was."

Question 57
Answer: C. was built
Explanation: The sentence is in the passive voice because the house is receiving the action (being built by someone). The past passive is formed with "was/were" + past participle. "The house was built last year." Options A, B, and D are either wrong tense or active voice.

Question 58
Answer: A. take
Explanation: "Had better" is followed by the base form of the verb (infinitive without "to"). "You had better take an umbrella." We never use "to" after "had better" or "would rather."

Question 59
Answer: D. Because of
Explanation: "Because of" is a preposition followed by a noun phrase ("the heavy rain"). "Because" is a conjunction followed by a clause. "In spite" needs "of" to become a preposition. "Due to the fact" is wordy; "due to the fact that" would be followed by a clause.

Question 60
Answer: B. when
Explanation: The structure "Scarcely had...when" is a fixed inversion pattern used to indicate that one event happened immediately after another. "Scarcely had she finished the exam when the bell rang." "Than" is used with "no sooner" (no sooner...than); "then" and "while" don't fit this structure.

III. Comprehension (Questions 61–68)

Question 61
Answer: B. since
Explanation: We use **"since"** with a specific point in time (2015). The present perfect continuous tense ("has been living") is used with "since" to indicate an action that started in the past and continues to the present. "For" is used with a duration of time (e.g., "for 5 years"), and "in" / "from" are not used with this tense in this way.

Question 62
Answer: C. out
Explanation: The phrasal verb **"point out"** means to indicate or draw attention to something. "I wanted to point out the error" = I wanted to indicate the error. "Point in," "point up," and "point on" are not standard phrasal verbs with this meaning.

Question 63
Answer: A. off

Explanation: The phrasal verb **"turn off"** means to switch off (lights, appliances). "Turn out" means to extinguish (lights) or produce, but "turn off" is the most common and direct choice for lights. "Turn down" means to reduce volume; "turn up" means to increase volume.

Question 64
Answer: C. do
Explanation: The verb **"make"** is followed by an object and the **base form of the verb** (infinitive without "to"). The structure is: *make + someone + do something*. "The teacher made the students do the exercise again." (We do not use "to do" or "-ing" after "make" in this causative structure.)

Question 65
Answer: D. had told
Explanation: This is a **mixed conditional** sentence. The "if" clause refers to a past action that didn't happen (he didn't tell the truth), and the main clause refers to a present result (I am angry now). The structure is: *If + past perfect (had told), would + base verb (wouldn't be)*. Therefore, "had told" is correct.

Question 66
Answer: A. A written notice is mandatory before retiring in order to get your pension.
Explanation: The original sentence means that **unless** you give a written notice **prior to** retirement, you will not receive your pension. This means the notice is a mandatory requirement that must happen **before** retirement. Option A accurately rephrases this. Option B says you can get it without notice (false), C says after retiring (false), and D says optional (false).

Question 67
Answer: B. I regret that I did not value my education properly in my youth.
Explanation: The phrase **"should not have taken"** expresses regret about a past action. The original sentence means the speaker did not appreciate their education when they were young, and now they regret it. Option B correctly captures this meaning.

Question 68
Answer: C. Presenting a doctor's note is a necessary condition for getting time off.
Explanation: The phrase **"unless you present"** means "if you do not present," making the doctor's note a necessary condition. Option C accurately states this. Option A is wrong (it says fired), B is wrong (says you can take time off without seeing a doctor), and D is wrong (doctors can give notes).

Section Two: Reading Comprehension (Questions 69–85)

Question 69
Answer: C. The importance of recognizing and addressing mental health.
Explanation: The entire passage discusses how mental health is neglected, what affects it, and how to address it. The central theme is clearly about the importance of mental health awareness and care. Options A, B, and D are not the main focus.

Question 70

Answer: C. They fear the societal stigma and being seen as weak.
Explanation: Paragraph 1 states: "Many individuals suffer in silence, believing that acknowledging their emotional or psychological pain is a sign of weakness." This directly matches option C.

Question 71
Answer: B. To make a problem worse or more severe.
Explanation: In context, "Chronic stress... and unhealthy relationships are known to **aggravate** underlying mental health conditions." This means these factors worsen the conditions. "Aggravate" means to make something worse, so option B is correct.

Question 72
Answer: C. These issues (factors affecting mental health).
Explanation: The sentence is: "When **these issues** are left unaddressed, **they** can escalate into severe anxiety disorders..." The pronoun "they" refers back to the "issues" (chronic stress, trauma, unhealthy relationships, social media use) mentioned earlier.

Question 73
Answer: B. It leads to feelings of isolation and inadequacy.
Explanation: Paragraph 2 states: "excessive use of social media often leads to feelings of inadequacy and isolation." This matches option B exactly.

Question 74
Answer: A. Physical health is much easier to diagnose and treat than mental health.
Explanation: The passage states: "While physical health issues are easily identified and treated, mental health struggles often remain hidden..." This implies that physical health is easier to diagnose and treat. Option A is a valid inference.

Question 75
Answer: C. In the end; fundamentally.
Explanation: "Ultimately" is used to indicate the final or most important point. In the sentence, "Ultimately, consulting therapists... is the most effective way," it means "in the end" or "fundamentally." Option C is the closest meaning.

Question 76
Answer: C. To seek professional support from therapists.
Explanation: Paragraph 3 states: "However, self-care is sometimes not enough. When individuals feel overwhelmed, it is vital to seek professional support." This is followed by a mention of therapists. Option C is correct.

Question 77
Answer: C. Taking strong medication
Explanation: Paragraph 3 mentions "Regular exercise, a balanced diet, and sufficient sleep" as foundational practices. Taking strong medication is **not** mentioned as a foundational practice; it is implied as a professional intervention, not a daily foundational habit.

Question 78

Answer: B. To compare hard skills and soft skills, highlighting the growing importance of soft skills.
Explanation: The passage introduces hard skills, then soft skills, and argues that soft skills are becoming more valuable. The main purpose is to compare them and show why soft skills are increasingly important. Option B captures this.

Question 79
Answer: C. Accounting
Explanation: Paragraph 1 lists hard skills: "programming, accounting, and fluency in a foreign language." Teamwork, emotional intelligence, and adaptability are all listed as soft skills in paragraph 2.

Question 80
Answer: C. Their soft skills.
Explanation: The sentence is: "...but **it** is their soft skills that allow them to effectively communicate..." The pronoun "it" in this cleft sentence refers to the phrase "their soft skills." (The structure is "it is X that..." where X is the emphasized element.)

Question 81
Answer: B. Soft skills are harder to teach to an employee than technical skills.
Explanation: Paragraph 3 states: "An employee lacking a specific technical skill can easily be trained... However, it is much more difficult to teach an arrogant employee how to be empathetic..." This directly supports option B.

Question 82
Answer: A. It makes human-centric soft skills more highly valued.
Explanation: The final sentence states: "As artificial intelligence continues to automate routine tasks, the human-centric soft skills will increasingly separate great employees from average ones." This implies AI makes soft skills more valued. Option A is correct.

Question 83
Answer: B. Transferable
Explanation: Paragraph 2 describes soft skills as "highly **transferable** across different industries." The definition of "transferable" is exactly "capable of being moved from one place/job to another."

Question 84
Answer: B. They might struggle to work effectively in a team environment.
Explanation: The passage emphasizes that soft skills (like teamwork and communication) are crucial for collaboration. An employee with poor soft skills would likely struggle with team interaction. Option B is a logical inference.

Question 85
Answer: B. Hard skills are generally specific to a profession, while soft skills apply across industries.

Explanation: Paragraph 2 explicitly states: "Unlike hard skills, which are specific to a particular profession, soft skills are highly transferable across different industries." Option B perfectly matches this.

IV. Vocabulary (Questions 86–100)

Question 86
Answer: A. lay off
Explanation: "Lay off" means to dismiss employees from their jobs due to economic reasons. The sentence mentions a "sharp drop in sales," so the factory had to dismiss workers. "Put off" = postpone; "take over" = assume control; "bring up" = raise a topic or a child.

Question 87
Answer: A. consists
Explanation: The correct phrasal verb is **"consists of,"** meaning "is made up of." The diet is made up of vegetables, proteins, and grains. "Contains" means has inside; "involves" means includes as a necessary part; "comprises" means includes, but the sentence uses "mostly... of," which pairs only with "consists."

Question 88
Answer: A. as well as
Explanation: "As well as" is a conjunction used to add additional items. "Mathematics as well as physics students" = both groups. "Also" is an adverb and cannot be used this way; "in addition" needs "to"; "beside" means "next to."

Question 89
Answer: D. no article
Explanation: When referring to the academic field or subject "economy" in a general sense (as an area of study), we use no article. "He is an expert in economy" (meaning economics as a field). If we say "the economy," it would refer to a specific country's economic system, which is not the intended meaning here.

Question 90
Answer: B. nominate
Explanation: "Nominate" means to formally suggest someone for an award or position. The committee suggested her for the award. "Terminate" = end; "procrastinate" = delay; "aggravate" = worsen.

Question 91
Answer: A. procrastinate
Explanation: "Procrastinate" means to delay or postpone action, especially unnecessarily. The sentence says he kept delaying until the night before the deadline. "Fascinate" = attract; "accelerate" = speed up; "nominate" = propose for a position.

Question 92
Answer: B. spectacular

Explanation: "Spectacular" means beautiful, impressive, and breathtaking. A sunrise from a mountain top would be described this way. "Boring" and "terrible" are negative; "substantive" means significant or meaningful, not visually impressive.

Question 93
Answer: B. substantive
Explanation: "Substantive" means substantial, significant, and having real importance. The lawyer presented significant evidence that changed the outcome. "Trivial" = unimportant; "weak" = not strong; "irrelevant" = not related.

Question 94
Answer: C. pulled down
Explanation: "Demolished" means torn down or destroyed completely. "Pulled down" is a synonym. "Repaired" = fixed; "constructed" = built; "painted" = applied color.

Question 95
Answer: A. investigate
Explanation: The phrasal verb **"look into"** means to investigate, examine, or research a matter. "Ignore" = pay no attention; "forget" = fail to remember; "hide" = conceal.

Question 96
Answer: B. irritate
Explanation: "Annoy" means to make someone slightly angry or irritated. "Irritate" is the closest synonym. "Please" = make happy; "entertain" = amuse; "assist" = help.

Question 97
Answer: C. infectious
Explanation: "Contagious" means a disease that can be transmitted from one person to another. "Infectious" is the direct synonym. "Curable" = able to be cured; "harmless" = not harmful; "rare" = uncommon.

Question 98
Answer: B. submit
Explanation: "Hand in" means to give something (like papers) to a person in authority, which is exactly what "submit" means. "Distribute" = give out; "tear up" = rip; "hide" = conceal.

Question 99
Answer: B. eliminate
Explanation: "Eradicate" means to completely destroy or get rid of something. "Eliminate" is the closest synonym. "Increase" = make larger; "support" = help; "ignore" = pay no attention.

Question 100
Answer: C. crucial
Explanation: "Vital" means extremely important or necessary. "Crucial" is a direct synonym. "Optional" = not required; "unnecessary" = not needed; "rare" = uncommon.



THE END
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